

Healthy Food on a Budget

Eating well shouldn't be a luxury. Federal programs, fresh-produce incentives, and nutrition help make healthy food more affordable. Below are trusted national starting points. Tick the box once you've looked into each one.

⚠ BEFORE YOU START

Many of these programs stretch your food budget toward fresh, healthy choices — and you may qualify even if you're working. Applying is always free.

1 Get Help Buying Groceries

Federal benefits put money toward food each month — the foundation of eating well on a budget.

☐ SNAP — Monthly Grocery Benefits

Money on a card for groceries, including fruits, vegetables, and healthy staples. Apply through your state.

→ www.fns.usda.gov/snap/recipient/eligibility

☐ WIC — Pregnant Women & Young Kids

Free healthy foods, formula, and nutrition support for families with children under 5.

→ www.fns.usda.gov/wic

2 Double Your Money on Fresh Produce

Programs that match your SNAP dollars when you buy fruits and vegetables.

☐ SNAP at Farmers Markets & Double Up

Many markets double your SNAP spending on fresh produce. Find participating markets and Double Up Food Bucks programs.

→ www.fns.usda.gov/snap/farmers-markets

☐ GusNIP Produce Incentives

Federal produce-incentive programs that stretch your fruit and vegetable budget. Find local programs.

→ www.nifa.usda.gov/grants/programs/hunger-food-security-programs/gus-schumacher-nutrition-incentive-program

3 Free Food & Healthy Choices

Food banks increasingly offer fresh produce, and nutrition help is free.

☐ Feeding America — Find Fresh Food

Many food banks now offer fresh produce, dairy, and proteins. Find one near you.

→ www.feedingamerica.org/find-your-local-foodbank

☐ MyPlate — Free Healthy Eating Guide

Free, simple guidance and budget recipes from the USDA.

→ www.myplate.gov/eat-healthy/healthy-eating-budget

4 For Seniors & Families

Targeted programs help older adults and families afford healthy food.

☐ Senior Farmers Market Nutrition Program

Coupons for fresh produce at farmers markets for eligible older adults. Ask your local agency on aging.

→ www.fns.usda.gov/sfmnp

☐ Eldercare Locator — Senior Meals

Connects older adults to congregate and home-delivered meal programs.

→ eldercare.acl.gov 1-800-677-1110

⚠ WATCH OUT FOR

Be skeptical of pricey “detox,” cleanse, or supplement programs marketed as healthy eating. Real, affordable nutrition comes from whole foods — and the programs above help you afford them.

★ A TIP THAT HELPS

Shop the produce in season and check whether your farmers market doubles SNAP dollars — it’s one of the easiest ways to get more fresh fruits and vegetables for your money.

NEED HELP WHERE YOU LIVE?

Need local food resources?

This guide covers national programs. For farmers markets, produce-incentive programs, and food help specific to your area, use the personalized AI search or ask in the Questions area, and we’ll help you find them.

MY NOTES — WHO I CALLED, WHEN, AND WHAT THEY SAID
